

How to Publish a New Post

One-time setup

1. Install Obsidian (free)

- Download from obsidian.md
- Open Obsidian → "Open folder as vault"
- Select your project folder: `~/projects/forkspoonandstraw`
- **Important:** go to Obsidian → Settings (gear icon) → **Files & Links** → turn on "**Detect all file extensions**". Without this, Obsidian hides `.mdx` files and you'll only see images.
- You'll see the entire project in the sidebar. Your posts live in `src/content/posts/`

2. Install GitHub Desktop (free)

- Download from desktop.github.com
- Sign in with your GitHub account
- **On your work computer (where the project already exists):** Click "Add" → "Add existing repository" → select `~/projects/forkspoonandstraw`
- **On a second/personal computer:** Click "Clone a repository" → select `leglick/forkspoonandstraw` → it downloads EVERYTHING (all 47 posts, all images, the whole site). Nothing gets lost.
- It'll show up in your repo list. Done.

Using two computers safely: GitHub is the source of truth. Both machines have a full copy. Before you start writing on either computer, always click "**Fetch origin**" first (top bar in GitHub Desktop). This pulls any changes from the other machine. As long as you fetch before writing and push after publishing, nothing gets deleted or overwritten. The only risk would be editing the exact same file on both computers without fetching - and even then, Git will warn you about the conflict instead of silently deleting anything.

Publishing a new post

Step 1: Create your post folder

In Finder, go to:

```
~/projects/forkspoonandstraw/src/content/posts/
```

Create a new folder. Name it your slug (lowercase, dashes, no spaces):

```
my-new-post-title/
```

Inside that folder, create an `images/` folder, then subfolders for each gallery section:

```
my-new-post-title/  
  images/  
    restaurant-name/  
    another-spot/
```

Drag your photos into the appropriate subfolders. Name them in the order you want them displayed (01.jpg, 02.jpg, etc. or descriptive names - the gallery sorts alphabetically).

Step 2: Write the post in Obsidian

In Obsidian's left sidebar, expand `(src)` → `(content)` → `(posts)` → your new folder. Right-click the folder → "New note". Obsidian will create a file - rename it to `(index.mdx)` (not `(index.md)`, the x matters because you're using the Gallery component).

Start with the frontmatter block and Gallery import at the very top:

```
---  
title: "Your Post Title Here"  
slug: your-post-title-here  
dek: "A one-sentence subtitle or teaser"  
categories:  
  - Travel  
date: 2026-08-04  
readTime: 6  
cover: ./images/cover.jpg  
description: "A short summary for SEO and social sharing previews."  
tags: ["toulouse", "food"]  
readNext: slug-of-another-post  
---
```

Field notes:

- **slug** must match your folder name exactly
- **categories** is an array (use the `(- Category)` format) - options: `(Travel)`, `(Pardon My Franglais)`, `(Food)`, `(Touloused & Confused)`
- **cover** is the cover image path (relative to the post folder)
- **description** is what shows in Google results and social shares
- **readTime** is a number in minutes
- **readNext** (optional) - slug of the post you want shown at the bottom. Leave it out and it picks one automatically

Category must be one of: `(Travel)`, `(Pardon My Franglais)`, `(Food)`, `(Touloused & Confused)`

Hero is the cover image path (relative to the post folder).

Then write your post below the frontmatter:

Your Section Heading

Your text goes here. Write naturally. For French words in italic, just wrap them in underscores: `_pépites_`, `_terrasse_`, `_coup de coeur_`. They'll automatically render in coral.

****Bold text**** works with double asterisks.

:::gallery{folder="restaurant-name"}

More text after the gallery...

Next Section

:::gallery{folder="another-spot"}

More text...

Step 3: Preview locally (optional but recommended)

Open Terminal and run:

```
cd ~/projects/forkspoonandstraw
npm run dev
```

Open `localhost:4321` in your browser. Find your post and check that everything looks right - galleries scroll, images are sharp, italics render in coral.

Post not showing up? Try these in order:

1. Make sure the file is saved in Obsidian (Cmd+S)
2. Check the file is named exactly `index.mdx` (not `index.md`, not `Index.mdx`)
3. Check your frontmatter has no typos - every field needs to match the template exactly, and the `---` lines must be there at top and bottom
4. Stop the dev server (Ctrl+C) and restart it (`npm run dev`) - sometimes Astro doesn't detect brand new folders until restart

Press `Ctrl+C` in Terminal to stop the preview when done.

Step 4: Publish

Open **GitHub Desktop**. It will show all your new/changed files in the left panel.

1. Type a short commit message in the box at the bottom left, something like: `new: restaurant name post`
2. Click **"Commit to main"**
3. Click **"Push origin"** (top bar)

Cloudflare auto-deploys. Your post is live in ~30 seconds.

Quick reference: formatting cheat sheet

What you want	What you type
French word in coral italic	<code>_pépites_</code>
Bold	<code>**bold text**</code>
Section heading	<code>##### Heading Text</code>
Photo gallery	<code>:::gallery{folder="section"}</code>
Regular link	<code>[link text](https://url.com)</code>
Single photo (not a gallery)	<code>![description](./images/folder/filename.jpg)</code>
Signoff	Already auto-added by the Signoff component

Editing an existing post

1. Open Obsidian
 2. Navigate to `src/content/posts/[post-slug]/index.mdx`
 3. Edit whatever you want
 4. Open GitHub Desktop → commit → push
 5. Live in 30 seconds
-

Troubleshooting

Images not showing in preview? Check the folder name in your

`:::gallery{folder="name"}` matches the actual folder name exactly (case-sensitive).

HEIC photos from your iPhone? Astro can't process .HEIC files and neither can browsers. Before adding photos, export them as JPEG from Photos (select images → File → Export → JPEG) or change your iPhone camera settings: Settings → Camera → Formats → "Most Compatible" (saves as JPEG instead of HEIC).

Post not appearing on the site? Check that the frontmatter `(date)` isn't set in the future. Check that `(category)` matches one of the four exact category names.

Italic French words not turning coral? Make sure you're using single underscores `_word_` not asterisks. Both create italics in markdown but check which one your prose stylesheet targets.